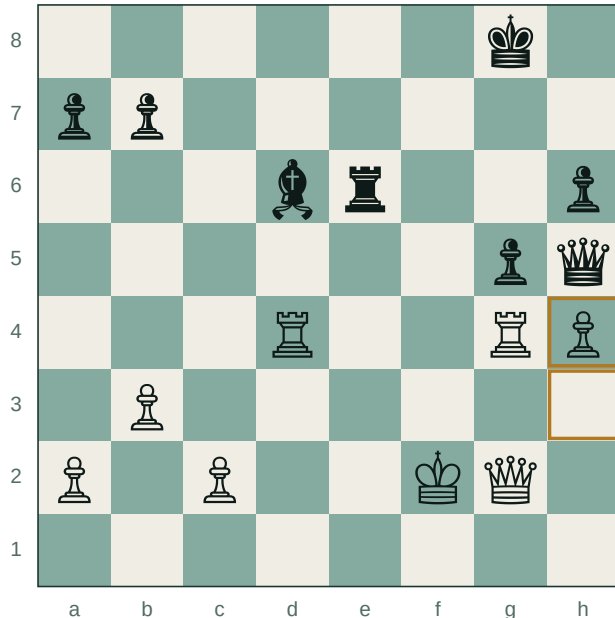


Pins and pressure: Black, move 30

Pins and pressure

Black to move



Previous move: 30.h4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

30...Qf7+ 31. Qf3 Rf6 32. Qxf6 Qxf6+

30...Qf7+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **31.Qf3**.

31...Rf6 The rook moves from e6 to f6. Recorded reply: **32.Qxf6**.

32...Qxf6+ Check restricts White to 7 legal replies here. From f6 it attacks king on f2 and rook on d4.

At the end, nominal material is White 14 / Black 16 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -2 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on f2. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.